

## Custom Table Block

To be reviewed with TFS as redesigned the authoring way.

### Summary

The custom-table-block( `data-list` ) block replaces the old AEM Table + Row approach with a single spreadsheet-driven pattern. Authors maintain a single spreadsheet (one source of truth). The block reads that spreadsheet's JSON and automatically builds search, filters, pagination and the item cards — same look-and-feel, much simpler authoring.

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### Key concept

Author fills rows in a spreadsheet (columns = fields). `data-list` fetches a JSON endpoint derived from that spreadsheet and:

- auto-extracts filter values from specified columns
- builds the search bar and filter dropdowns
- renders item cards (title, date, image, description, link)

Authors only edit the spreadsheet and block config.

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### Example spreadsheet (columns)

| title     | date       | end-date   | location      | description       | link                | image             | event-type | country       | month    | search-keywords  |
|-----------|------------|------------|---------------|-------------------|---------------------|-------------------|------------|---------------|----------|------------------|
| SLAS 2026 | 2026-02-07 | 2026-02-11 | Boston, MA US | Short event blurb | /events/latest-2026 | /images/slasp.jpg | Tradeshow  | United States | February | SLAS, Automation |

### Column roles

- Display: `title, date, description, image, link`

- Filters: `event-type, country, month` (these columns become the filter dropdowns)
  - Search: `search-keywords` (hidden, used for text search)
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## Block configuration (what the author sets in the editor)

The `data-list` block exposes the familiar options authors expect:

- **Data Source** (text) — path to spreadsheet JSON endpoint (e.g. `/events-data`)
  - **Searchable** (boolean) — enable text search bar
  - **Filterable** (boolean) — enable filter dropdowns
  - **Filter Columns** (text) — comma-separated column names to use as facets (e.g. `event-type, country, month`)
  - **Enable Pagination** (boolean) — show pagination controls
  - **Default per page** (select) — 5 / 10 / 15 / 20 / 25
  - **Left Navigation for Filters** (boolean) — place filters in left rail vs top bar
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## Authoring workflows

Add a new item (example: event)

1. Open spreadsheet (e.g., `events.xlsx`).
2. Add a new row and fill fields (title, date, location, image, event-type, etc.).
3. Save the spreadsheet.
4. Page renders the new item automatically — no page-edit in AEM required.

Remove an expired item

- Delete the row from the spreadsheet and save. Filters update automatically if that removed row was the last instance of a value.

Bulk update

- Edit many cells in the spreadsheet (e.g., change 20 dates), save once.
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## Comparison: AEM Table (today) vs EDS `data-list` (proposed)

| Concern          | AEM Table + Rows                         | EDS <code>data-list</code>      |
|------------------|------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| Where data lives | Table config + many Row child components | One spreadsheet (single source) |

|                  |                                               |                                   |
|------------------|-----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| Defining filters | Manual list in Table config + per-row mapping | Derived from spreadsheet columns  |
| Add new item     | Add Row in AEM, map filters, publish          | Add row in spreadsheet, save      |
| Bulk edits       | Edit each Row individually                    | Edit spreadsheet cells, save once |

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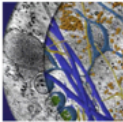


Event Type - Country - Month -

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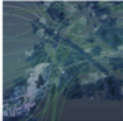
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